



WHAT MAKES A GREAT PERSON?

SESSION 2 · BUILD YOUR CRITERIA, THEN TEST THEM

1 YOUR CRITERIA

Tick five alone. Then agree on three as a team.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ courage – doing the right thing when it is dangerous | ☐ changing other people's lives for the better |
| ☐ intelligence – seeing what other people do not see | ☐ being honest, also when it costs something |
| ☐ hard work – years of it, not one good day | ☐ being famous – everybody knows your name |
| ☐ kindness – caring about people with no power | ☐ having power – you can decide things |
| ☐ never giving up | ☐ being remembered a long time after you die |

OUR TEAM'S THREE CRITERIA	WHY THIS ONE AND NOT ANOTHER?

2 EVIDENCE HUNT

No year, no evidence.

#	CRITERION	WHAT ELIZABETH ACTUALLY DID	YEAR
1			
2			
3			



3 THE GREATNESS TEST

Four things she really did. Score each 1–3 against YOUR criteria.

1. She said no to every marriage and kept the power herself (1558–1603). 1 2 3 ☐☐☐
Nobody ruled England through her. But she had no child, and after her death the crown went to Scotland.
2. She sent her ships against the Spanish Armada and spoke to the soldiers herself at Tilbury (1588). 1 2 3 ☐☐☐
England won. But the war was expensive, and she was careful with money for her soldiers afterwards.
3. After the rising in the north of England in 1569, more than 750 people were executed on her orders. 1 2 3 ☐☐☐
She kept the country quiet. Think about the price.
4. From 1581, to make an English person a Catholic was treason, and treason meant death. 1 2 3 ☐☐☐
She said it was about the state, not about God. Her enemies said it was about God.

4 BOTH SIDES

A team that cannot argue the other side has not understood its own.

Motion: “Elizabeth I was a great person.” Write three arguments on each side. You will need the right-hand column when you present.

FOR – BECAUSE SHE ...	AGAINST – BUT SHE ...

WHERE THE HARD FACTS IN TASK 3 COME FROM

Where the hard numbers in task 3 come from: the 750+ executions after the 1569 Rising of the North and the 1581 treason law are both stated in the Wikipedia article “Elizabeth I”, which also records that she at first resisted calls for the execution of Mary, Queen of Scots, signed the warrant in 1586, and afterwards blamed her secretary for sending it – and that historians have questioned how sincere that was. The article also notes that economic and military problems weakened her popularity late in the reign, and that some historians read her as short-tempered and sometimes indecisive. None of this is on the reading sheet; it is here so that a team that wants to argue the hard side can be given something real.